

Arizona State University (ASU) AI Strategy — Downloadable-Artifact Evidence Brief for Tarleton PAC

Scope note. I prioritized downloadable files only: PDFs/PPTs and other directly downloadable artifacts. I also checked Tarleton internal context and found the PAC workshop email confirming that ASU was selected as one of the three case-study institutions, specifically framed as “Principled Innovation AI Strategy & Campus Wide Enterprise Integration,” with the July 27 session using Gartner’s one-page AI strategy dimensions: value, people/culture, engineering, governance/organization, and data [1](#).

1. Executive Summary

ASU’s publicly documented AI strategy is not presented as a single “AI strategic plan” PDF; instead, it appears as a **federated institutional strategy** across Enterprise Technology, Academic Enterprise, EdPlus, Knowledge Enterprise/ research, and unit-level policy. The strongest primary evidence is ASU Enterprise Technology’s **FY26 Strategic Priorities**, which names “Advancing learning at scale with ethically-guided AI,” “Transformation towards a dynamic AI-centric organization,” “Information security,” “Data, analytics and insight,” and “Digital transformation” as AI-relevant institutional priorities [2](#). This is the closest downloadable artifact to an institutional roadmap.

The strategic pillars evident across ASU artifacts are:

1. **AI at institutional scale.** ASU’s FY26 technology priorities call for AI-enhanced teaching and learning, custom platforms for AI-powered solutions, enriched integrated data sources for personalized learner feedback, AI-powered precision health and medical education platforms, AI data security/privacy frameworks, and AI-powered operational efficiency [2](#).
2. **Responsible / principled innovation.** ASU’s Digital Trust guidelines state that ASU is committed to “Principled Innovation” and frame generative AI use around privacy, FERPA, intellectual property, vendor risk, disclosure, and transparency [3](#).

3. **AI enablement for faculty, staff, and students.** ASU's University Senate presentation documents a Faculty GenAI Literacy Course with **1,500+ faculty, staff, and student workers enrolled, 49 ASU experts contributing**, and modules on fundamentals, applications, ethical use, prompting, output evaluation, and teaching integration [4](#).
4. **Partnership-led experimentation.** ASU's OpenAI collaboration is documented in the Enterprise Technology AI seminar deck as the first university collaboration with OpenAI, bringing ChatGPT Edu capabilities into academic, research, and work environments [5](#). Engineering faculty minutes also show internal discussion about ASU's OpenAI partnership, faculty/staff use, Knowledge Enterprise idea submissions, and potential ASU-data use with masked student identities [6](#).
5. **AI workforce and curriculum expansion.** ASU's AI MS Engineering handbook shows a broad interdisciplinary AI engineering program across aerospace, chemical, electrical, human-centered AI, biomedical systems, manufacturing, materials, mechanical, operations/decision science, robotics, software engineering, and sustainable engineering concentrations [7](#).
6. **Operational AI and administrative transformation.** ASU's FY26 priorities explicitly include AI-powered solutions for data analytics user experience, operational efficiency, digital worker equivalents, identity/access modernization, digital infrastructure, and student-facing processes such as financial aid and matriculation [2](#).
7. **Evidence-driven AI experimentation.** ASU's AI Innovation Challenge is documented as having **550+ proposals submitted and 220 projects activated**, across teaching and learning, research, and future-of-work impact areas [5](#).

Why ASU is a leader: the downloadable evidence shows ASU has moved beyond AI as a research topic into a systemwide operating model: enterprise priorities, approved tool review processes, faculty literacy programs, innovation challenges, OpenAI/ChatGPT Edu experimentation, AI curriculum, digital trust governance, and operational use cases are all present in primary downloadable artifacts [2](#) [3](#) [4](#) [5](#).

2. Structured Findings Table

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Enterprise Strategy	FY26 Enterprise Technology Strategic Priorities	ASU Enterprise Technology frames its north star as integrating emerging and disruptive technology into learning ecosystems, communications, and operations. AI appears across priorities including AI-centric organization, ethically guided learning, information security, data/analytics, and digital transformation 2 .	Institutional roadmap for AI-enabled learning, operations, data, security, and workforce transformation.	https://tech.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz4026/files/2025-07/FY26%20Strategic%20Priorities.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Governance / Risk	Digital Trust Guidelines for Generative Artificial Intelligence Use	Guidelines address FERPA, student/personnel/confidential data, IP, vendor risk, VITRA assessment, disclosure, transparency, and policy resources. It states ASU community members should use approved tools to benefit from data privacy, cybersecurity terms, and risk mitigations 3 .	Establish responsible use guardrails for GenAI adoption across academics, research, and administration.	https://tech.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz4026/files/2023-09/Digital%20Trust%20genAI.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Governance / Academic Integrity	School of Social Transformation Generative AI Policy	Unit-level policy requires disclosure when GenAI is permitted, treats nondisclosure as academic dishonesty, provides impermissible use language, and defaults to “permissible use with disclosure” if no instructor/committee policy is clearly conveyed ⁸ .	Shows distributed governance model: central guidance plus unit-level implementation.	https://sst.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz446/files/2026-04/SST-Generative-AI-Policy-2026-For-Students.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Faculty Enablement	Teaching and Learning With Generative AI Course	Senate presentation documents a Faculty GenAI Literacy Course with 1,500+ enrolled and 49 ASU experts contributing. Modules cover fundamentals, applications, ethical/responsible use, prompting, evaluation, and integration with teaching and learning ⁴ .	Build AI literacy and teaching capacity at scale.	https://usenate.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz3301/files/2024-02/SM5_Provost_Friedrich_Senate_Presentation_1.29.24.pptx

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Partnerships	ASU + OpenAI / ChatGPT Edu	Enterprise Technology deck states ASU made global headlines in January 2024 as the first university to collaborate with OpenAI and that the collaboration brings ChatGPT Edu capabilities into higher education academic, research, and work environments 5 .	Strategic external partnership to accelerate AI experimentation across mission areas.	https://asura.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz301/files/2025-02/Feb132025AISeminarSlideDeckFinal.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Innovation Portfolio	AI Innovation Challenge	ASU deck describes challenge areas: support teaching and learning, advance research with societal impact, and enhance the future of work. It reports 550+ proposals submitted and 220 projects activated across three semesters 5 .	Crowdsource and scale high-value AI use cases across the institution.	https://asura.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz301/files/2025-02/Feb132025AISeminarSlideDeckFinal.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Teaching / Student Tools	“Sam” AI-powered bot for health sciences	ASU seminar deck describes “Sam,” an AI chatbot for health sciences students to practice motivational interviewing, simulate patient interactions, and receive immediate feedback ⁵ .	Use AI simulation to improve applied professional learning.	https://asura.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz301/files/2025-02/Feb132025AISeminarSlideDeckFinal.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Teaching / Student Tools	Language Buddy	ASU seminar deck describes a custom AI tool used by German 101 students to practice speaking asynchronously and receive immediate feedback, with plans to expand capabilities for personalized language learning ⁵ .	Expand personalized, feedback-rich student practice.	https://asura.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz301/files/2025-02/Feb132025AISeminarSlideDeckFinal.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Curriculum	Artificial Intelligence Engineering MS Handbook	The handbook describes a 30-credit interdisciplinary AI engineering MS with common AI core, ethics/social responsibility, AI systems/tools, data/evaluation, and multiple engineering concentrations ⁷ .	Build domain-integrated AI workforce pipelines.	https://ai-ms.engineering.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/124/2026/06/2026-2027-AI-MS-Handbook.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Curriculum	Artificial Intelligence MS Graduate Handbook	SCAI handbook states the MS in AI develops scientists and engineers with competencies in autonomous decision-making, perception, reasoning, statistical learning, and embodied intelligence ⁹ .	Core AI talent development within computing and augmented intelligence.	https://scai.engineering.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/31/2026/06/AI-MS-Handbook-2026-2027.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Responsible AI / Ethics	Responsible Innovation and Artificial Intelligence	Future of Being Human briefing defines responsible innovation and responsible AI, discussing ethical, sustainable, socially beneficial, privacy, accountability, and bias concerns 10 .	Thought-leadership framework for responsible AI governance and culture.	https://futureofbeinghuman.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/52/2025/04/Responsible-Innovation-and-AI.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Responsible AI / Foresight	Responsible Innovation and Responsible AI in an Era of Accelerated AI Development	Report argues traditional responsible innovation frameworks may be inadequate under accelerated AI futures characterized by speed, secrecy, and geopolitical rivalry ¹¹ .	Strategic foresight for governance stress-testing.	https://futureofbeinghuman.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/52/2025/04/Responsible-innovation-and-AI-acceleration.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Operations / Health	AI for Resilient Healthcare Systems White Paper	W. P. Carey white paper covers AI in diagnostics, clinical decision support, supply chain management , population health analytics, workforce/ HR, and clinical care 12 .	Domain-specific model for AI translation into operations, policy, workforce, and cross-sector innovation.	https://wpcarey.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz246/files/2026-02/AI-For-Resilient-Healthcare-Systems-The-Journey-From-Algorithm-to-Action.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Student Innovation / Funding	AI Accelerated Spark Challenge	Flyer describes a week-long hackathon using ASU's Sol supercomputer, NVIDIA tools, GPUs, LLMs, and Python notebooks; prizes are \$3,000, \$2,000, and \$1,000, with digital credentials 13 .	Build AI workforce skills and applied prototypes using institutional compute.	https://asuevents.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz3506/files/2025-06/LOCKED_AI%20Accelerated%20Spark%201%20PGR%20%2B%20QR.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Student Innovation / Funding	Arizona AI Challenge Flyer	Flyer invites Arizona higher-ed students to prototype AI tools for inclusive excellence, with two finalist teams receiving \$5,000 awards and a later \$15,000 seed-fund opportunity ¹⁴ .	Expand AI entrepreneurship and inclusive student innovation.	https://asuevents.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz3506/files/2025-10/Arizona%20AI%20Challenge%20Flyer.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Evaluation / Governance	AI Challenge Evaluation Rubric	Rubric assesses relevance to higher education, innovation, educational impact, feasibility, scalability, AI tool use, ethics, evidence/metrics, teamwork, and project maturity ¹⁵ .	Provides an evaluative framework for AI pilots and student innovation.	https://poweredby.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/2026/06/AI-Challenge-Evaluation-Rubric-revAB.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Faculty Governance	Engineering Faculty Executive Committee Minutes — Jan. 19, 2024	Minutes document ASU's OpenAI partnership discussion, including faculty/staff opportunities, Knowledge Enterprise idea submissions, enterprise ChatGPT license questions, ASU data, and masked student identities ⁶ .	Shows governance discussion and faculty concerns at school/college level.	https://faculty.engineering.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/2024/02/EC_MINUTES_2024_01_19.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Faculty Governance	Engineering Faculty Executive Committee Minutes — Feb. 2, 2024	Minutes document continued discussion of OpenAI collaboration and an “ASU AI Innovation Challenge” RFP communicated to faculty ¹⁶ .	Shows institutional ideation pipeline and faculty engagement around AI partnership.	https://faculty.engineering.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/2024/08/EC_MINUTES_2024_02_02.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Faculty Governance	Engineering Faculty Executive Committee Minutes — Feb. 7, 2025	Minutes document discussions of AI use, academic integrity violations, syllabus expectations, assignment-level instructions, course redesign, grading at scale, and reporting violations 17 .	Shows academic governance adapting pedagogy and integrity processes to GenAI.	https://faculty.engineering.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/2026/01/EC_MINUTES_2025_02_07-1.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Enterprise Accomplishments	FY25 Enterprise Technology Strategic Priorities Accomplishments	Report documents AI Creative Learning Labs, Creative Compass AI assistant, AI-powered microcredentials, Adobe activations, AI writing-companion study, Tri-U AI Community of Practice, and platform/program progress 18 .	Evidence of execution against AI-enabled learning and digital transformation.	https://tech.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz4026/files/2025-11/FY25%20Strategic%20Priorities%20Year%20End%20Accomplishments%20-%20Enterprise%20Technology.pdf

Category	Initiative / Program	Description	Strategic Purpose	Direct Download Link
Policy Template / External-facing	Best Practices for Designing an AI Use Policy	ASU Mechanics of Democracy Lab document provides best practices for organizational AI use policies, including goals, scope, values, risks, acceptable practices, oversight, transparency, and stakeholder communication 19 .	Reusable AI governance framework, especially useful for Tarleton policy design.	https://modl.spa.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz3876/files/workshop-references/Best%20practices%20for%20designing%20an%20AI%20use%20policy.pdf

3. Consolidated Downloadable Files List

Title	Type	Brief Description	Direct Download Link
FY26 Strategic Priorities	PDF	ASU Enterprise Technology's AI-forward strategic roadmap across learning, data, security, operations, and transformation ² .	https://tech.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz4026/files/2025-07/FY26%20Strategic%20Priorities.pdf
Digital Trust Guidelines for Generative Artificial Intelligence Use	PDF	Central ASU GenAI responsible-use guidelines covering FERPA, confidential data, IP, disclosure, approved tools, VITRA, and policy resources ³ .	https://tech.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz4026/files/2023-09/Digital%20Trust%20genAI.pdf
SM5_Provost_Friedrich_Senate_Presentation_1.29.24	PPTX	Faculty GenAI Literacy Course and ASU teaching/learning AI resources, approved guidelines, VITRA-reviewed tools ⁴ .	https://usenate.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz3301/files/2024-02/SM5_Provost_Friedrich_Senate_Presentation_1.29.24.pptx

Title	Type	Brief Description	Direct Download Link
Feb132025AISeminarSlideDeckFinal	PDF	Enterprise Technology AI overview with ASU guiding tenets, OpenAI collaboration, ChatGPT Edu, AI Innovation Challenge metrics, student tools 5 .	https://asura.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz301/files/2025-02/Feb132025AISeminarSlideDeckFinal.pdf
2026-2027 AI MS Handbook	PDF	Interdisciplinary AI Engineering MS program handbook, concentrations, AI ethics/social responsibility core, applied project/thesis options 7 .	https://ai-ms.engineering.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/124/2026/06/2026-2027-AI-MS-Handbook.pdf

Title	Type	Brief Description	Direct Download Link
AI-MS-Handbook-2026-2027	PDF	SCAI Artificial Intelligence MS handbook focused on autonomous decision-making, perception, reasoning, statistical learning, embodied intelligence ⁹ .	https://scai.engineering.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/31/2026/06/AI-MS-Handbook-2026-2027.pdf
Responsible Innovation and AI	PDF	ASU Future of Being Human responsible AI briefing ¹⁰ .	https://futureofbeinghuman.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/52/2025/04/Responsible-Innovation-and-AI.pdf
Responsible Innovation and AI Acceleration	PDF	ASU Future of Being Human foresight report on accelerated AI and governance limitations ¹¹ .	https://futureofbeinghuman.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/52/2025/04/Responsible-innovation-and-AI-acceleration.pdf

Title	Type	Brief Description	Direct Download Link
AI For Resilient Healthcare Systems	PDF	W. P. Carey white paper on AI, healthcare operations, workforce, supply chain, clinical care, and policy translation ¹² .	https://wpcarey.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz246/files/2026-02/AI-For-Resilient-Healthcare-Systems-The-Journey-From-Algorithm-to-Action.pdf
FY25 Strategic Priorities Year End Accomplishments	PDF	Enterprise Technology execution report with AI Creative Learning Labs, Creative Compass AI assistant, microcredentials, AI writing study, and Tri-U AI Community of Practice ¹⁸ .	https://tech.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz4026/files/2025-11/FY25%20Strategic%20Priorities%20Year%20End%20Accomplishments%20-%20Enterprise%20Technology.pdf
SST Generative AI Policy 2026 For Students	PDF	Unit-level GenAI disclosure/default-use policy for undergraduate and graduate work ⁸ .	https://sst.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz446/files/2026-04/SST-Generative-AI-Policy-2026_For-Students.pdf

Title	Type	Brief Description	Direct Download Link
Best Practices for Designing an AI Use Policy	PDF	ASU MODL guide for AI-use policy design, scope, risk, values, oversight, and acceptable practices ¹⁹ .	https://modl.spa.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz3876/files/workshop-references/Best%20practices%20for%20designing%20an%20AI%20use%20policy.pdf
AI Accelerated Spark Challenge	PDF	Student AI hackathon using ASU Sol supercomputer, NVIDIA, GPUs, LLMs; includes prize model and credentials ¹³ .	https://asuevents.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz3506/files/2025-06/LOCKED_AI%20Accelerated%20Spark%201%20PGR%20%2B%20QR.pdf
Arizona AI Challenge Flyer	PDF	Statewide higher-ed AI challenge for inclusive excellence; includes awards and seed-fund pathway ¹⁴ .	https://asuevents.asu.edu/sites/g/files/litvpz3506/files/2025-10/Arizona%20AI%20Challenge%20Flyer.pdf

Title	Type	Brief Description	Direct Download Link
AI Challenge Evaluation Rubric	PDF	Rubric for judging AI projects on higher-ed relevance, innovation, feasibility, scalability, ethics, metrics, and maturity ¹⁵ .	https://poweredby.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/2026/06/AI-Challenge-Evaluation-Rubric-revAB.pdf
Engineering Faculty Executive Committee Minutes — Jan. 19, 2024	PDF	Faculty governance discussion of OpenAI partnership, enterprise ChatGPT, ASU data, masked student identities, teaching/ research ideas ⁶ .	https://faculty.engineering.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/2024/02/EC_MINUTES_2024_01_19.pdf
Engineering Faculty Executive Committee Minutes — Feb. 2, 2024	PDF	Continued OpenAI collaboration discussion and ASU AI Innovation Challenge RFP reference ¹⁶ .	https://faculty.engineering.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/2024/08/EC_MINUTES_2024_02_02.pdf

Title	Type	Brief Description	Direct Download Link
Engineering Faculty Executive Committee Minutes — Feb. 7, 2025	PDF	Academic-integrity and pedagogy discussion around GenAI use, syllabus expectations, course redesign, grading, and violation reporting ¹⁷ .	https://faculty.engineering.asu.edu/wp-content/uploads/2026/01/EC_MINUTES_2025_02_07-1.pdf

4. Analysis by Strategic Dimension

Governance, ethics, and policy

ASU's governance posture is **risk-managed enablement**, not blanket prohibition. The Digital Trust guidelines warn users not to share student, personnel, confidential, proprietary, or valuable IP information with public GenAI tools, and emphasize that ASU-approved tools benefit from agreed privacy/cybersecurity terms and risk mitigations ³. The same artifact links governance to existing policy infrastructure: student privacy, release of student information, personnel records, intellectual property, ethics, professional conduct, employee conduct, research policy, academic integrity, and research integrity ³.

Governance is distributed. The Senate presentation says ASU's guidelines were reviewed and approved by Enterprise Technology Digital Trust, Cybersecurity, AI Acceleration, Learning Experience, and the Office of General Counsel ⁴. The School of Social Transformation policy shows local academic units translating central guidance into concrete course, capstone, thesis, dissertation, and committee expectations ⁸.

Teaching, learning, and faculty enablement

ASU's teaching strategy is built around **literacy + tool governance + pilots**. The Faculty GenAI Literacy Course is documented with >1,500 enrollees, 49 expert contributors, and modules from fundamentals to ethical/responsible use and teaching integration [4](#). ASU also documents student-facing AI tools such as “Sam” for health sciences motivational interviewing and “Language Buddy” for German 101 speaking practice [5](#).

ASU's AI Innovation Challenge operationalizes experimentation. The ASU seminar deck identifies three impact areas: teaching and learning, research with societal impact, and future of work; it reports 550+ proposals and 220 activated projects [5](#). This is strong evidence that ASU's model is not just policy but **portfolio-based institutional learning**.

Curriculum and workforce

ASU's AI curriculum evidence is broad and domain-integrated. The AI Engineering MS handbook requires at least 30 credits and includes a common core with **FSE 561 Artificial Intelligence Ethics and Social Responsibility**, AI engineering foundations, AI systems/tools, and data collection/evaluation for AI systems [7](#). Concentrations span aerospace, chemical, electrical, human-centered AI, biomedical systems, manufacturing, materials, mechanical, operations/decision science, robotics, software engineering, and sustainable engineering [7](#).

The SCAI AI MS handbook emphasizes advanced AI research competencies in autonomous decision-making, perception, reasoning, statistical learning, and embodied intelligence [9](#). Together, these documents show ASU positioning AI as both a technical discipline and a cross-domain workforce capability.

Operations and enterprise transformation

The FY26 Enterprise Technology priorities are the clearest evidence of operational strategy. They call for custom platforms for AI-powered solutions, enriched data sources for personalized learner feedback, AI-powered precision health and medical education platforms, AI data security/privacy frameworks, AI-powered data analytics user experiences, digital worker equivalents, and AI-powered operational efficiency across ASU [2](#).

The FY25 accomplishments report provides execution evidence: AI Creative Learning Labs, Creative Compass AI assistant, AI-powered microcredentials, an IRB-approved longitudinal study on AI as a writing companion, the Tri-U AI Community of Practice, and platform work such as ASU Portfolio and Trusted Learner Network [18](#).

Partnerships and funding

The OpenAI partnership is the most visible strategic partnership. ASU's seminar deck states ASU was the first university to collaborate with OpenAI and that ChatGPT Edu capabilities support academic, research, and work environments [5](#). Engineering faculty minutes further document internal discussion about faculty/staff use, Knowledge Enterprise idea submissions, ASU data, masked student identities, and proposal ideation [6](#).

Funding evidence is most visible through challenge and seed-funding artifacts rather than a full budget. The AI Accelerated Spark Challenge includes prizes of \$3,000, \$2,000, and \$1,000 and digital credentials [13](#). The Arizona AI Challenge includes \$5,000 finalist awards and a later \$15,000 seed-fund opportunity [14](#). The Canon Volumetric Innovation Challenge, while broader than AI, offers up to three projects \$10,000–\$50,000 each for Gaussian-splatting-enabled volumetric capture research [20](#).

5. Insights for Tarleton — PAC Discussion-Worthy Takeaways

1. **Adopt an AI strategy as an operating model, not a document.** ASU's evidence suggests strategy lives in enterprise technology priorities, faculty governance, curriculum, tool approval, literacy programs, innovation challenges, and unit policies—not only a single plan [2](#) [3](#).

PAC decision: Should Tarleton create a one-page AI strategy plus a portfolio governance model?

2. **Create a Tarleton AI Trust / Approved Tools pathway.** ASU's Digital Trust guidance and VITRA reference show the value of an approved-tool process tied to privacy, cybersecurity, FERPA, IP, and procurement [3](#) [4](#).

PAC decision: Who owns AI tool approval: IT, legal/compliance, academic affairs, data governance, or a joint AI council?

3. **Launch a faculty/staff/student AI literacy program before broad deployment.** ASU scaled faculty enablement through a structured GenAI literacy course with modules on fundamentals, ethics, prompting, evaluation, and teaching integration [4](#).

PAC decision: Should Tarleton make AI literacy baseline training for all employees and optional/required modules for students?

4. **Fund AI experimentation through challenge cycles.** ASU's Innovation Challenge model surfaced hundreds of proposals and activated projects across teaching, research, and work [5](#).

PAC decision: Should Tarleton create a small internal AI Innovation Fund with rubric-based selection and required assessment?

5. **Separate acceptable-use policy from pedagogical autonomy.** ASU combines central Digital Trust guidance with unit-level and course-level policies, including disclosure-based use and impermissible-use language [3](#) [8](#).

PAC decision: Should Tarleton define university-wide defaults while allowing faculty assignment-level decisions?

6. **Make AI part of workforce and curriculum strategy, not just IT strategy.** ASU's AI Engineering MS embeds ethics, AI systems, data/evaluation, and domain concentrations [7](#).

PAC decision: Which Tarleton programs should become "AI-infused" first—business, education, health, agriculture, criminal justice, computer science, or general education?

7. **Use administrative AI pilots where value and risk are both visible.** ASU's FY26 priorities point to AI in data analytics, digital worker equivalents, operational efficiency, financial aid, matriculation, identity/access, and personalized digital interactions [2](#).

PAC decision: What are Tarleton's top 3 administrative AI pilots with measurable ROI, student impact, and risk controls?

6. Gaps and Unknowns

The public downloadable record is substantial but incomplete. I did **not** find a single ASU-authored downloadable “AI Strategy Roadmap” or “AI Strategic Plan” that formally consolidates governance, funding, partnerships, technology architecture, and success metrics. The closest institutional roadmap is Enterprise Technology’s FY26 Strategic Priorities [2](#).

Key gaps:

- **No public full AI governance charter.** ASU documents guidelines, policy resources, review groups, and faculty governance discussions, but I did not find a downloadable charter defining an enterprise AI council, decision rights, escalation paths, risk tiers, or approval thresholds [3](#) [4](#).
 - **Limited financial disclosure.** Public files show prize amounts and some challenge funding, but not the full cost of ChatGPT Edu, OpenAI agreement terms, enterprise AI platform budgets, staffing, or recurring AI investment model [5](#) [13](#) [14](#).
 - **OpenAI contract details are not public in retrieved downloadable artifacts.** Files document the partnership and internal discussion, but not the legal agreement, data-processing terms, pricing, model access, or deployment architecture [5](#) [6](#).
 - **AI portfolio outcomes are only partially disclosed.** The Innovation Challenge has proposal/project counts, but the full list of 220 projects, evaluation outcomes, ROI, continuation decisions, and institutional scaling decisions were not in the downloadable artifacts retrieved [5](#).
 - **Operational AI use cases are strategic but not fully specified.** FY26 priorities mention AI-powered analytics, digital worker equivalents, and operational efficiency, but do not provide detailed implementation plans, owners, timelines, or KPIs in the public artifact [2](#).
 - **Student-facing tool governance is not fully visible.** ASU references approved GenAI tools and VITRA-reviewed tools, but I did not retrieve a downloadable full approved-tool catalog with risk ratings, data classifications, and permitted use cases [4](#) [3](#).
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Bottom Line for PAC

ASU's AI strategy is best characterized as **“principled, enterprise-scale AI experimentation with centralized trust guardrails and distributed academic innovation.”** The most transferable elements for Tarleton are: a one-page AI strategy, an AI trust/approved-tools process, an AI literacy program, an innovation challenge fund, domain-specific curriculum infusion, and a measured administrative AI pilot portfolio.